Install Python

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Time required: 15 minutes

Python Editors

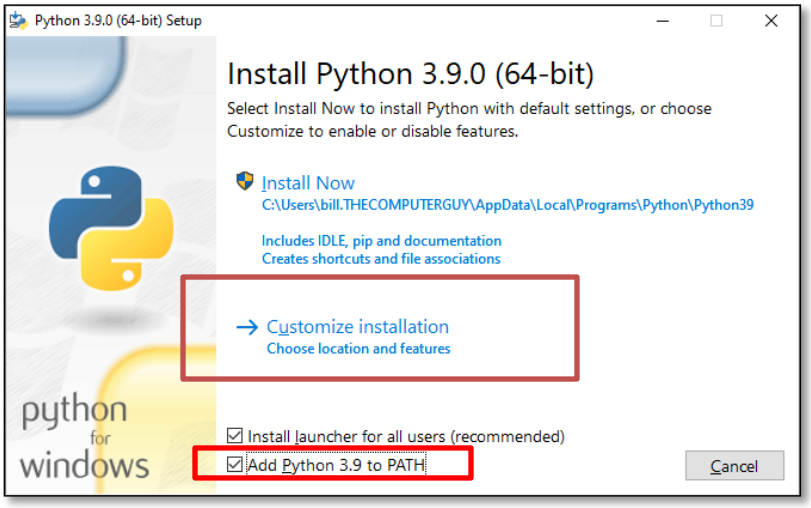
We will use **Visual Code Studio** to create, run, and edit our Python programs.

Install Python

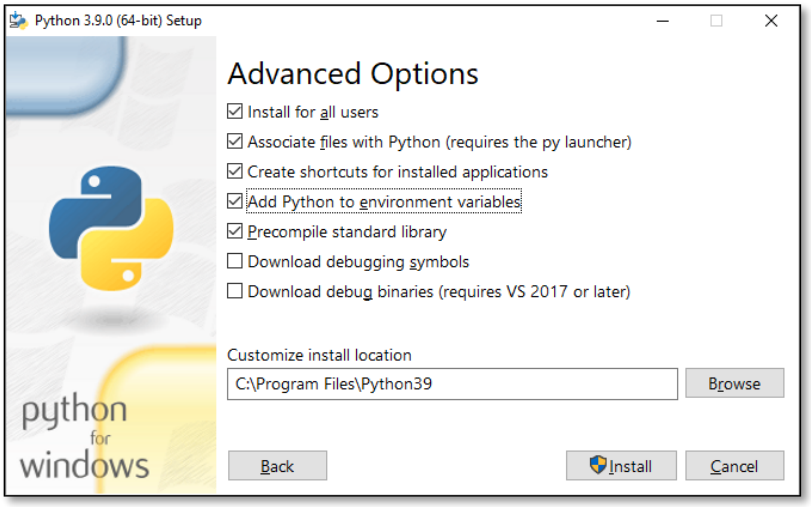
There is a version of Python for almost any operating system.

1. Go to https://www.python.org/downloads
2. Download the latest Python 3 release for your operating system.
3. Click **Download Python 3.11.1** (This was the latest version as of this writing. Download the latest version)
4. Double Click the file you downloaded to start the installation.

5. Click **Customize installation**.



6. Click Next until you come to **Advanced Options**.



7. Click **Install Now**.

8. Setup should be successful.

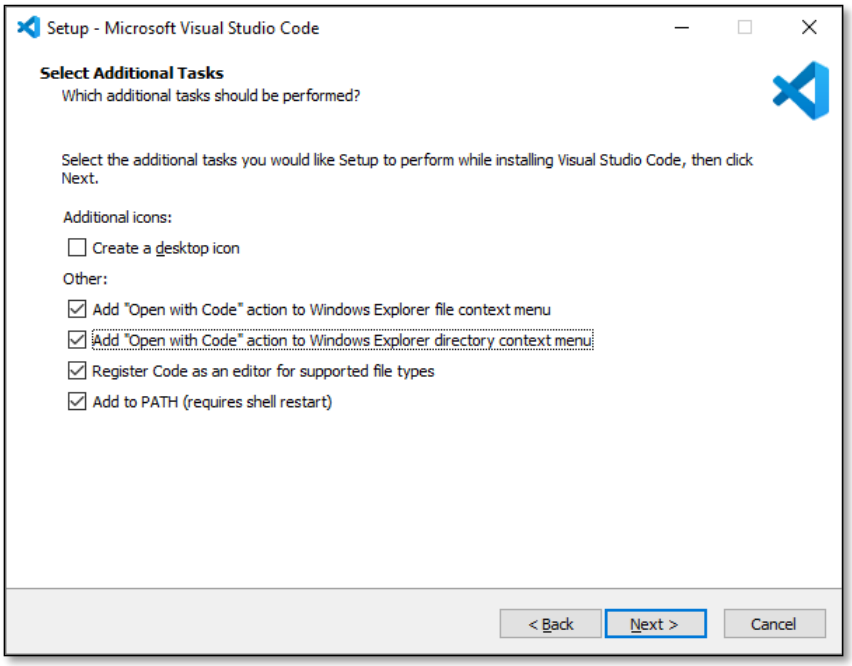
Install Visual Studio Code

There is extensive information on how to get started with Visual Studio Code and Python on the Visual Studio Code website.

1. Go to code.VisualStudio.com You want to find **Visual Studio Code**.

2. Download and install the **System Installer 64 bit** version of Visual Studio Code for your operating system.

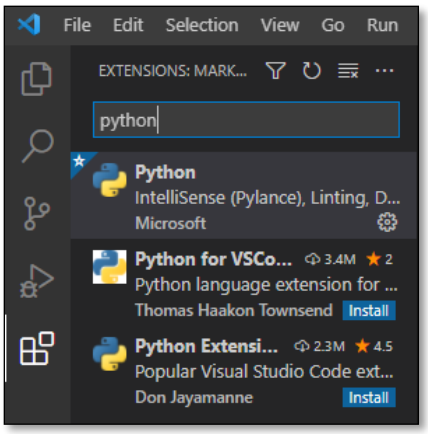
3. During the installation: **Select Additional Tasks**, select the following items. You can create a desktop icon if you wish.



Setup Visual Studio Code to Edit Python Programs

1. Run Visual Studio Code.

2. Go to the **Extensions** button on the left navigation bar → search for **Python**. You will see **Python IntelliSense by Microsoft**. Click **Install**.



Tutorial 1: Hello World!

This is traditionally the first program written in a new programming language. It is a good way to test your development environment to make sure everything is working.

We will write and run the traditional "Hello World!" program from a Python program file.

1. Launch **Visual Studio Code**.
2. Click **File** → **Save As**. Save your program as **hello_world.py**
3. Enter the following code required to print a **Hello World!** message.

```
"""
    Name: hello_world.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: My first Python program
"""

# Print the literal string Hello World!
print("Hello World!")
```

4. Press **F5** to run the program.
5. Your program should print **Hello World!** in the terminal.
6. Example run:

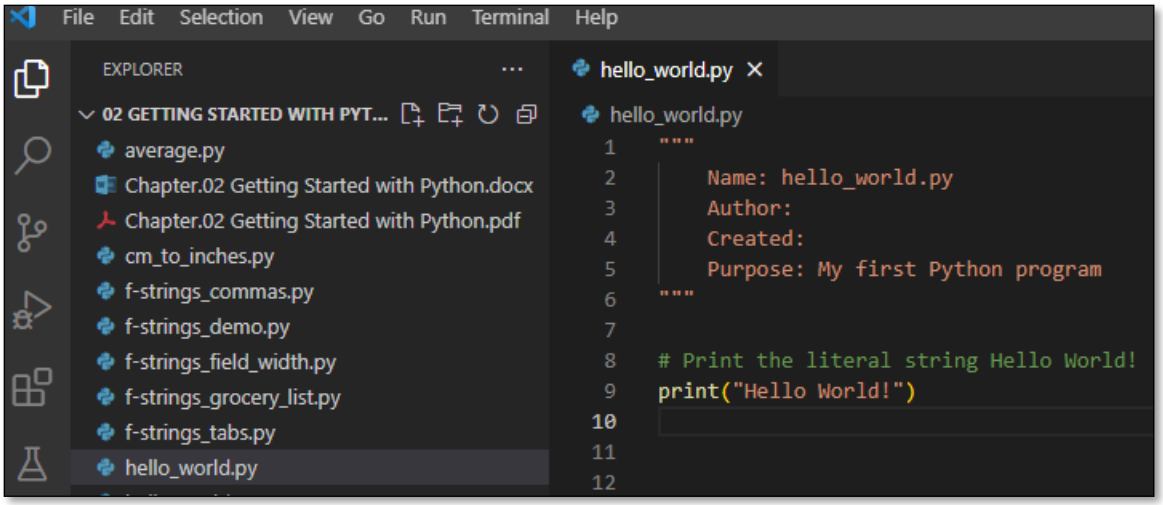
```
Z:\_WNCC\Python\Assignments\02 Getting S
thon\debugpy\adapter/../..\debugpy\launc
Hello Python World! Let's start coding!!
```

Congratulations! You created your first program in Python.

Open Folder with Visual Studio Code

Visual Studio Code works better if you open the folder that the program file is in.

1. In **File Explorer** → **Navigate** to the folder the program file is in → **Right Click** the folder → **Open with Code**.
2. You can Double Click the file on the left-hand side to edit.
3. F5 will run the program.



Optional: Other IDE's

These are all free.

- www.geany.org
- https://www.jetbrains.com/pycharm

Optional: Online IDE's

There are many online environments for executing Python programs.

- www.repl.it
- colab.research.google.com (Online Jupyter Notebook)

(Optional) Double Click .py Files to Edit with IDLE

1. Open a folder that contains a Python file.
2. Right-click on any Python file.
3. Select **Properties**.
4. Next to the section that says **Opens with**, Click **Change**.
5. Select **More Apps.**
6. Scroll to the bottom and Click **Look for another app on this PC**
7. Navigate to where you installed Python: **C:\Program Files\Python311**

8. Open **Lib** → Open **idlelib**
9. Select **idle.bat**
10. Click **Open**. Click **OK**.

You can open **.py** files in IDLE by double-clicking on them.